

Dartmouth Innovative Project Studio (D.I.P.S)

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A common belief that I encounter amongst students at Dartmouth is that portfolios and independent projects only exist to serve future purposes: job applications, grad school applications, professional networking, etc. The feedback on these projects tends to be external and treated simply as a means to an end. This produces **a culture where creative work goes undocumented if it isn't impressive or professional enough**. Independent projects or class assignments quickly become **devalued**. Additionally, students who are not in STEM, Art, or Business fields, where digital portfolios are not as commonly requested, often regard their other project work as useless. I want to create **a space where every project has a purpose, is seen, and can live for future students to reference and gain inspiration from**.

With DIPS, students can display their work, any work, for the Dartmouth community. Here, representation and appreciation will thrive. DIPS bets that exhibiting work changes how students **value** it in the first place.



HANNAH WELLS

Dartmouth Undergrad

Junior

Human Centered Design Minor

Behaviors:

Vibecoding: Uses AI tools (Claude Code, Codex, etc.) to prototype and build on ideas.

Web Design: Likes to build fun and interactive websites and expand on projects she worked on in class.



"I have all these projects but nowhere to put them where people will actually see them, and when I do find someone doing cool work, there's no easy way to reach out."

Goals:

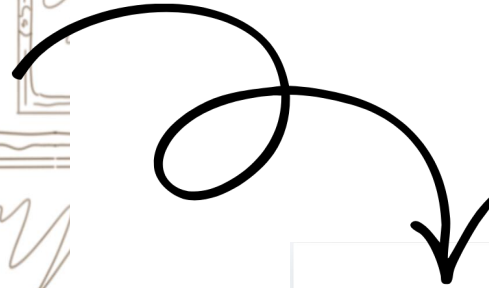
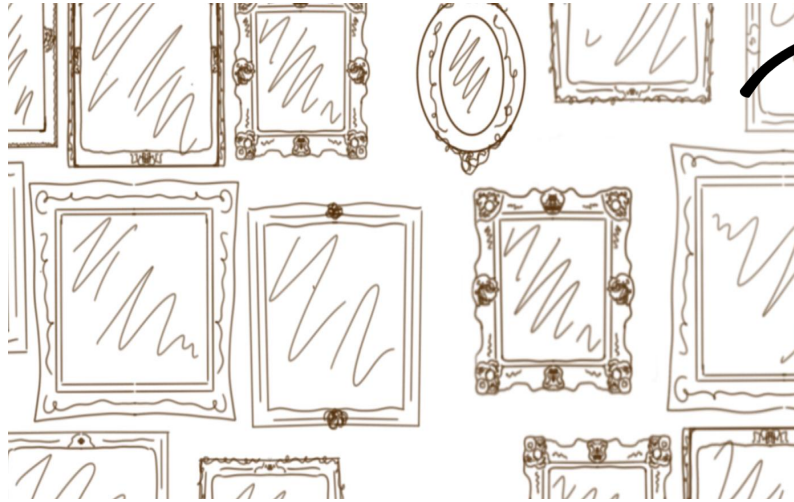
- Build coding projects that stand out for internships and research positions
- Find collaborators across CS, art, and engineering to bring her interdisciplinary ideas to life
- Get feedback on her work from peers and workshop ideas
- Discover what other Dartmouth students are building and stay inspired

Pains:

- No centralized place to share work
- Hard to find students outside her major who share her interests or have complementary skills
- Cold emailing strangers to collaborate feels awkward and rarely gets a response
- Existing platforms (LinkedIn, Behance, etc.) feel too formal or too disconnected from campus

[Click me!](#)

Version/Week 1: Paper & Pencil Version to Canva Draft #1

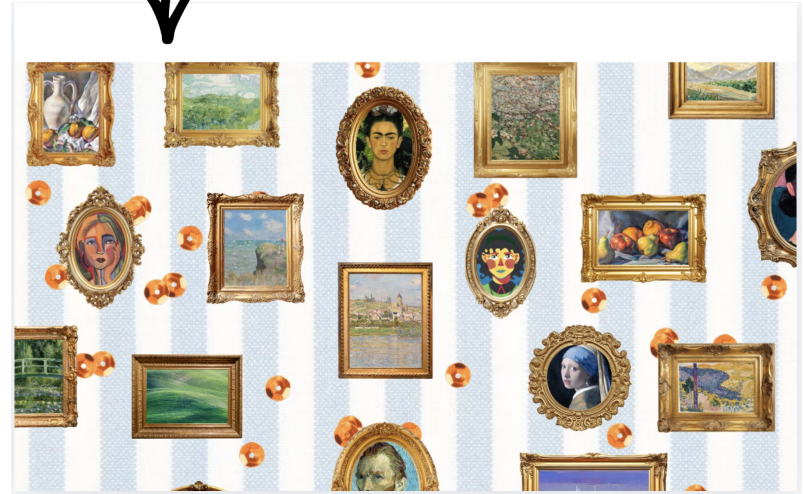


No room for navigation or search feature

No directions for how to use site

Critiques & Changes:

Design seems too busy and pastel; should be simple enough that is tasteful to different audiences



Version/Week 2: Finalized Landing Page Design & Intro to Claude

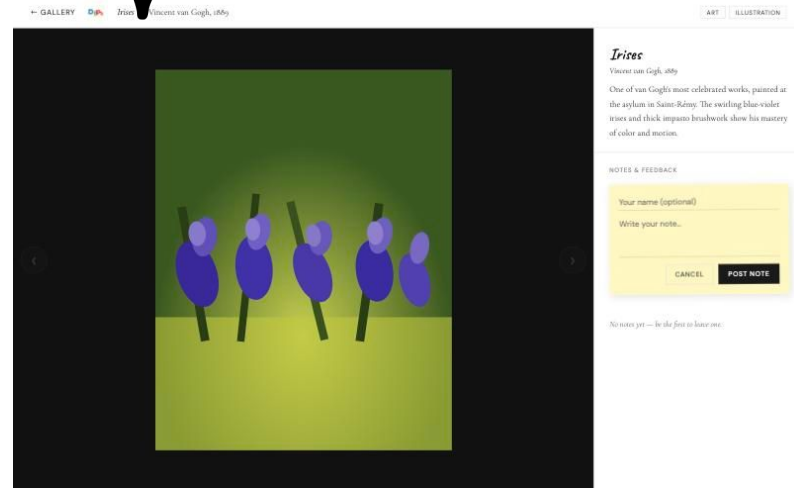


Realistic photo frames replaced by AI design

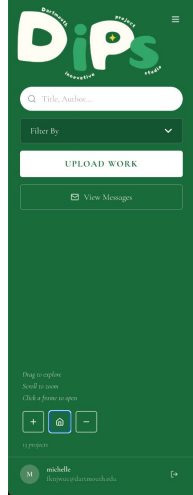
Art was being created instead of sourced

Critiques & Changes:

Claude prompts were too vague; resulted in Claude's own iteration of the design



Version/Week 3: Finalized Claude Code App and Features



Message system for collaborations

Ability to close the sidebar for full view

User Test Results & Change:

Ability to write in filters so that users can get specific with their designs and what they are looking for

The screenshot shows the 'Upload Your Work' form in the Dips app. The form is white with a close button (X) in the top right corner. It has a progress indicator at the top with three dots, the first of which is green. The form fields include: 'TITLE *' with a placeholder 'Project title'; 'YOUR NAME * (from your account)' with the value 'michelle'; 'DEPARTMENT *' with a dropdown menu showing 'Select...' and a 'CLASS CODE' field with the value 'e.g. ENGS 15.15'; 'DESCRIPTION *' with a placeholder 'Describe your project...'; and 'TAGS (COMMA-SEPARATED)' with a placeholder 'art, design, sustainability...'. A green 'Continue' button is at the bottom.

Throughout this course, I have seen my **confidence in design** grow considerably. This course has pushed me to run through the design process, from ideation to creation, without giving me the time to second guess myself or stray from my first few original ideas. This has given me the confidence to run with the first idea that strikes my interest and aligns with my passions and I think this has allowed me to create better projects overall.

As a designer, I have now discovered that I work best with service design and designs that look at the stakeholders and challenges holistically. This course has given me the opportunity to explore many different styles and theories of design. This has allowed me to identify that I feel the **most passionate about designing for people and services**, as I have done in my final project.